

Homework 03

Jocelyn Magner

2026-05-20

Table of contents

Set up	2
Problems	2
Problem 1. Giant Kelp Fronds	2
a. An Appropriate Test	2
b. Visualizing Data	2
c. Check Assumptions and Run Test	3
d. Results Communication	5
e. Test Implications	6
f. Run Other Correlation Test	6
Problem 2. Personal Data	6
a. Updating Visualizations	6
b. Captions	9
Problem 3. Affective Visualization	10
a.	10
b.	10
c.	10
d.	10
e.	11
Problem 4. Statistical Critique	11
a.	11
b.	11
c.	11
d.	11

Set up

```
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(janitor)
library(readxl)
library(ggeffects)

# store personal data
my_data <- read_csv(here("data" , "personaldatapoint.csv"))

# store kelp data
temp_kelp <- read_csv(here("data", "temp-kelp.csv"))
```

Problems

Problem 1. Giant Kelp Fronds

a. An Appropriate Test

Pearson and Spearman correlations could be used to determine strength of the relationship between temperature and giant kelp frond elongation rate assuming observations are independent. Pearson's correlation also assumes a linear relationship exists and it is a parametric test meaning it assumes variables are normally distributed. Spearman's correlation assumes a monotonic relationship and it is a nonparametric test meaning normality is not an assumption.

b. Visualizing Data

Showing the relationship between temperature and giant kelp frond elongation rate.

```
# plot raw data points to observe potential linear relationship

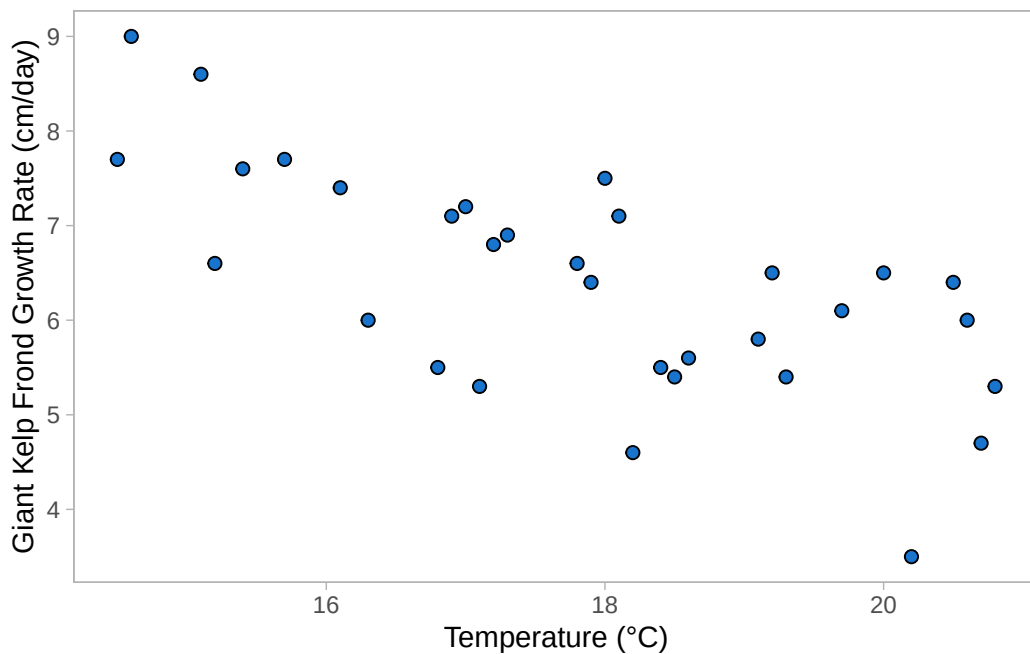
# base layer ggplot
ggplot(data = temp_kelp,
       # assign data to axes
       aes(x = temp_c,
           y = kelp_elong))+
# first layer: add scatter points
geom_point(size = 2,
```

```

      stroke = 0.5,
      fill = "dodgerblue3",
      shape = 21)+

# relabel axis with units
labs(x = "Temperature (°C)",
     y = "Giant Kelp Frond Growth Rate (cm/day)")+
# change theme
theme_light()+
theme(panel.grid = element_blank())

```



```

# data appears fairly linear, proceed with diagnostic tests

```

c. Check Assumptions and Run Test

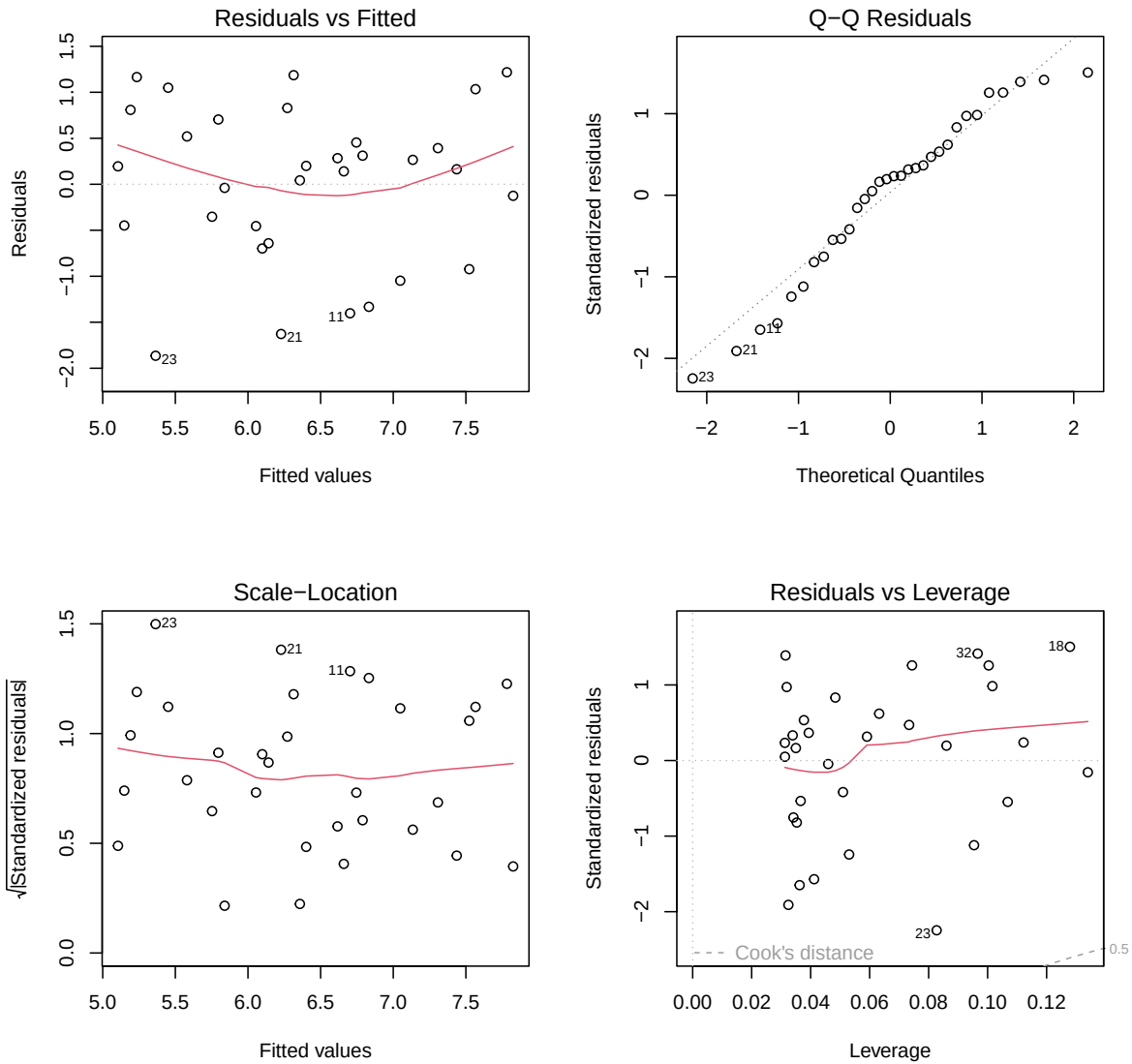
```

# create object storing linear model data to perform diagnostic tests
temp_kelp_model <- lm(kelp_elong~temp_c,
                      data = temp_kelp)

# diagnostic plots

```

```
par(mfrow = c(2,2))
plot(temp_kelp_model)
```



Assumption of Pearson's correlation

To check the assumptions of a Pearson correlation test I evaluated the linearity, continuous data, normality and independence of observations.

I checked linearity by looking at the scatter plot generated in 1b; if I drew a line from the lowest temp/highest growth rate point to one of the high-temp/low-growth points the data would fall around that line. Temperature and growth rate are both continuous variables (they can be measured to decimal places or fractions). Looking at diagnostic QQ plot, the data appears normally distributed since the data follows the line closely only deviating strongly in the tails which is acceptable. Finally, the assumption of independent variables is a potential limitation since the study design does not explicitly say if the kelp fronds were isolated in separate, independently regulated tanks; however, we are going to proceed with the analysis.

Run a correlation test

```
# Run Pearson Correlation test
cor.test(temp_kelp$kelp_elong, # predicted/y value
         temp_kelp$temp_c,     # predictor/x value
         method = "pearson")  # use pearson method
```

Pearson's product-moment correlation

```
data: temp_kelp$kelp_elong and temp_kelp$temp_c
t = -5.189, df = 30, p-value = 1.366e-05
alternative hypothesis: true correlation is not equal to 0
95 percent confidence interval:
 -0.8359665 -0.4460157
sample estimates:
      cor
-0.6877489
```

d. Results Communication

To evaluate the strength of the relationship between temperature and giant kelp frond elongation rate, I used a Pearson's Correlation test. The data appears to be normally distributed based on the QQ plot diagnostic test meaning this parametric test is fitting.

We found a moderate-to-strong negative relationship between giant kelp frond elongation rate (in cm/day) and Temperature (in degrees Celsius) (Pearson's $r = -0.69$, $t(30) = -5.19$, $p < 0.01$, $= 0.05$).

e. Test Implications

Our tests suggest a moderately strong statistically significant negative relationship ($r = -0.69$, $p < 0.01$) between temperature and kelp growth, meaning that giant kelp frond elongations rates decrease as water temperatures rise. To maximize conservation efforts I would suggest prioritizing protecting the cooler areas where kelp has higher chances of survival.

f. Run Other Correlation Test

```
# Run Spearman Correlation test
cor.test(temp_kelp$kelp_elong, # predicted/y value
         temp_kelp$temp_c,     # predictor/x value
         method = "spearman") # change method to spearman
```

Spearman's rank correlation rho

```
data: temp_kelp$kelp_elong and temp_kelp$temp_c
S = 9216.1, p-value = 1.29e-05
alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
sample estimates:
      rho
-0.6891684
```

Both of these test lead me to reject the null hypothesis because they both yielded a p-value < 0.01 . Both methods lead me to say there is a moderate-to-strong negative relationship between water temperature and giant kelp frond elongation rate because the Spearman rank coefficient ($\rho = -0.689$) is close to the Pearson correlation coefficient (Pearson's $r = -0.688$). This directly relates to the variables by confirming that as the continuous variable of water temperature increases, the giant kelp frond elongation rate decreases, a trend that remains robust whether measured linearly (with Pearson) or monotonically through ranked data (with Spearman).

Problem 2. Personal Data

a. Updating Visualizations

```

# organize day of week column so variable shows up in chronological order
# instead of alphabetical
my_data$day_of_the_week <- factor(my_data$day_of_the_week,
levels = c("Monday", "Tuesday", "Wednesday",
"Thursday", "Friday", "Saturday",
"Sunday"))
# create plot, assign x and y values.
# X is a categorical predictor variable, Y is response variable.
ggplot(my_data, aes(x = day_of_the_week, y = perceived_stress_level))+

# create jitter plot with custom color
geom_jitter(height = 0,
            width = 0.2,
            shape = 21,
            size = 3,,
            fill = "lightpink",
            alpha = 0.8,
            color = "hotpink") +
# change graph title and axis titles

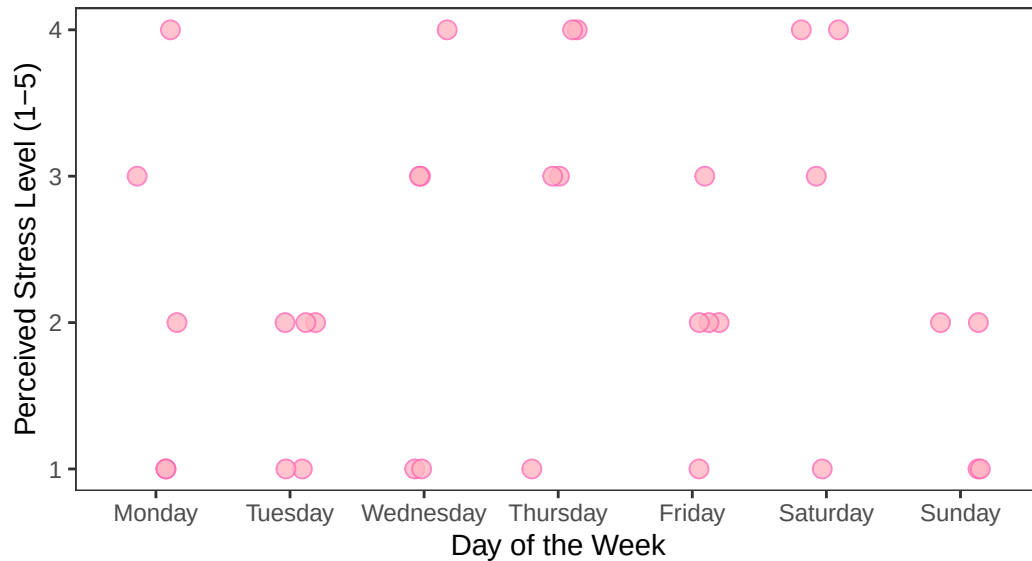
labs(title = "Perceived Stress by Day of the Week",
      subtitle = "5/22/2026",
x = "Day of the Week",
y = "Perceived Stress Level (1-5)")+

# change theme
theme_bw()+
# remove grid
theme(panel.grid = element_blank())

```

Perceived Stress by Day of the Week

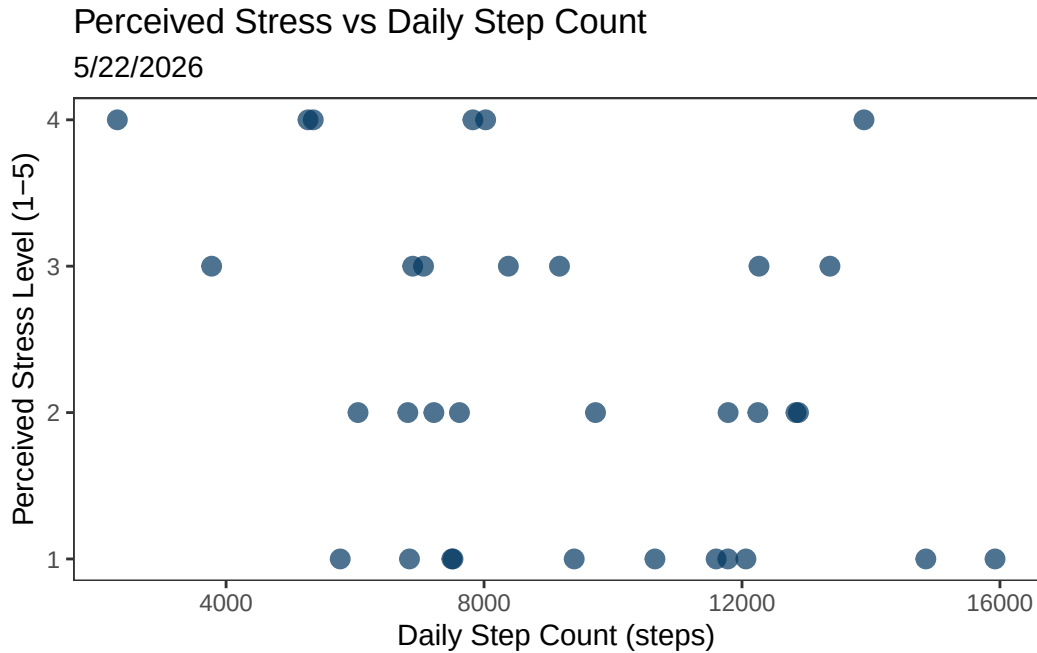
5/22/2026



```
# create plot, assign x and y values
# X is my discrete predictor variable, Y is response variable.
ggplot(my_data, aes(x = daily_step_count, y = perceived_stress_level))+
#create plot with custom color
geom_point(shape = 19,
           size = 3,
           alpha = 0.7,
           color = "#003660") +
# change graph title and axis titles
labs(title = "Perceived Stress vs Daily Step Count",
     subtitle = "5/22/2026",
     x = "Daily Step Count (steps)",
     y = "Perceived Stress Level (1-5)")+

# choosing non-default theme
theme_bw()+

# remove grid
theme(panel.grid = element_blank())
```

b. Captions

Figure 1. Day of the week appears to have little impact on perceived stress level. Each pink circle represents a single day's self-reported stress level on a scale of 1-5. The points are jittered and semi-transparent to show overlapping points. Days of the week are represented on the x axis, ordered from Monday to Sunday. There appears to be examples of low stress everyday of the week and high stress almost everyday. Tuesdays, Fridays, and Sundays tend to be lower stress. Wednesdays, Thursdays, and Saturdays appear to be the highest stress day of the week. Day of the week is the categorical predictor variable and stress is the categorical response variable.

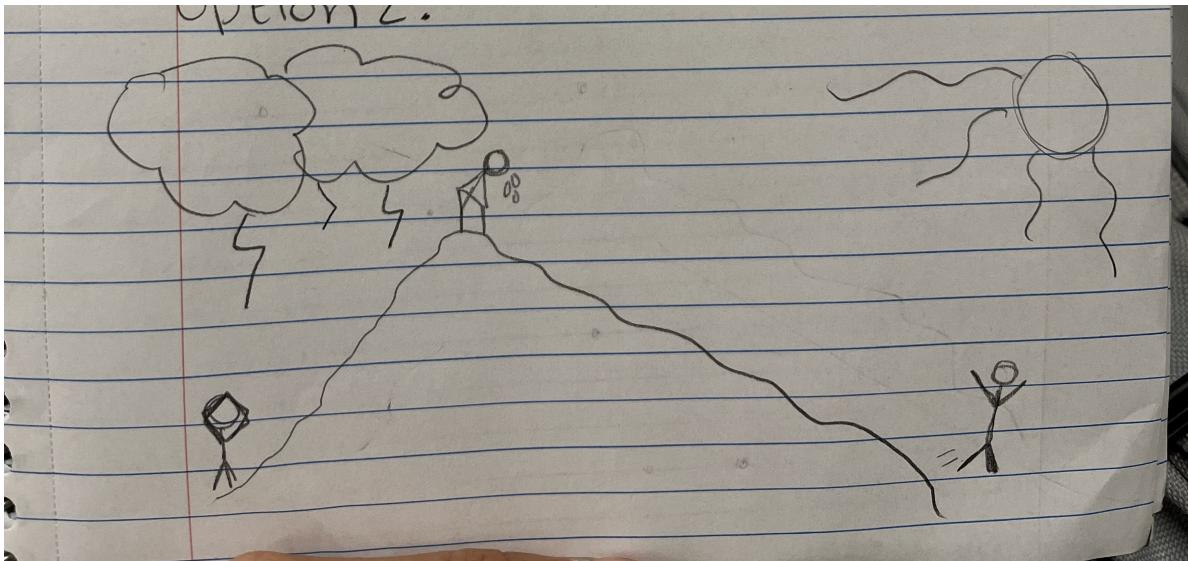
Figure 2. There appears to be a potential negative linear relationship between perceived stress level and daily step count. The navy blue dots represent a single day's self-reported stress level on a scale of 1-5 and are ordered on the x axis by daily step count recorded by a fitbit watch. Daily step count is the discrete predictor variable and stress is the categorical response variable.

Problem 3. Affective Visualization

a.

I imagine an affective visualization for day of the week vs stress relationship could be represented by circles in a circle since the days of the week feel circular to me. The size and color of each circle could represent the more stressful days and maybe more jagged outlines for the more stressful days. I could imagine for the step count vs stress something more like Jill Pelto's work, nature inspired. I could see a mountain representing steps it takes to get to a less stressed mindset since I observed a potential linear relationship. Either of these could be done in watercolor for a final draft.

b.



c.

d.

Context: This piece represents daily step count's relationship with daily stress level.

Influences: I was inspired by Jill Pelto's paintings.

Form: I will complete my final design in water color.

Process: I started my process by drafting with pencil and paper. I then made a digital redition with color. Finally I mapped my digital design onto water color paper and painted the final design.

e.

Problem 4. Statistical Critique

a.

b.

c.

d.